

2026 Medical Placement: Four Bids, Re-Rated

Every vendor quoted Onyx on a census that isn't ours. This report re-prices all four bids against actual enrollment — four enrolled, ten covered lives — so the numbers compare. Onyx's contribution target of \$300 / \$600 / \$1,000 is applied throughout.

EFFECTIVE DATE 10/01/2026	ENROLLING 4 of 5 · 10 lives	GROSS PAYROLL \$658,322	TRINET QUOTE Q-00412887	INSPERITY BID 8143360-11	ANGLE QUOTE 400798
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Angle offers the best coverage at the lowest cost. Among the PEOs, it's ADP.

Angle Health wins on every measurable axis in year one — better plan designs, lower employee cost, and \$12,181 less employer spend than the cheapest PEO. It carries two risks the PEOs don't: a renewal you expect at **+40%**, and a scope gap (no payroll, HR, workers' comp or EPLI) that nobody has priced. If Onyx wants one vendor for everything, **ADP TotalSource** is the answer — cheapest all-in, the lowest contribution floor in the field, the only vendor that lets us curate the plan menu, and the single best plan design on any PEO's shelf.

RANKING · ALL FOUR BIDDERS

Best coverage per dollar

1 Angle Health

\$34,800 employer · via CapFi

Best designs in the field and the cheapest for everyone. A \$1,000-deductible plan with a \$2,000 out-of-pocket max costs a family \$694/mo — less than the PEOs charge for mid-tier coverage. Held back only by renewal risk and unpriced scope.

2 ADP TotalSource

\$46,981 year 1 · floor \$187.02

Cheapest PEO all-in, lowest floor, and the only vendor where we pick the lineup. Its EPO HDHP 2500-100Coplay is the best plan any PEO offers.

3 TriNet / Aetna

\$51,567 year 1 · floor \$269.50 confirmed

Twelve plans and a broad POS network, but the **\$14,400 admin floor is now confirmed** — the one thing that could have closed the gap did not. Mid-tier premiums run \$6,000–\$12,000 above ADP's equivalents.

4 Insuperity Saver

\$53,436 year 1 · floor \$509.76

Now the most expensive of the three *and* the weakest coverage. Highest floor forces Onyx above target, and its cheapest plan still runs \$604/mo employee-only.

Why ADP beats TriNet

- **\$4,586 less** in year-one employer cost — and this figure is now firm, since TriNet has confirmed the \$1,200/month minimum applies.
- Floor of **\$187.02** vs \$269.50 — both clear our \$300 target, but ADP leaves the most room.
- Its \$2,500-deductible plan caps a member at **\$3,500** and pays **100%** after deductible. TriNet's closest rung has a \$6,850 cap. *But see the household-by-household comparison — for the two family tiers TriNet's ACO 6500 beats it.*
- ADP's fee is 1.53% of payroll and stays below TriNet's \$14,400 floor until payroll reaches **~\$941,000**.
- ADP lets us present 3–5 plans. Insuperity requires the full menu. TriNet says all twelve are *available* — whether that obliges us to offer all twelve is not yet confirmed, and it matters less than it looks: offering the cheapest plan is what holds the floor at \$269.50.

Why TriNet beats Insuperity

- TriNet is **\$1,869 cheaper** in year one — and Insuperity's life and LTD rates were never quoted, so its real figure is higher still.
- Insuperity's cheapest plan — a \$6,500 deductible at \$604/mo — costs more than TriNet's **richest mid-tier** plans.
- Insuperity's floor of \$509.76 pushes Onyx **\$2,517 above** the contribution target and buys Lisa a \$5,000-deductible plan for it.
- Insuperity offers **seven rungs to TriNet's twelve**, and its two cheapest carry the highest out-of-pocket maximums in the field — \$9,200 and \$8,500 for an individual.
- Every Insuperity plan costs a family more than **\$871/mo** after Onyx's \$1,000 — more than ADP's mid-tier plans charge, on a \$6,500 deductible.

What Onyx pays, required versus optional

The medical contribution line is *plan-independent* — it is our contribution formula, not any vendor's price, and it does not move when an employee changes plans. Only a vendor's floor can override it, which happens at Insuperity alone.

Employer-only annual cost 4 enrolled · contribution \$300 / \$600 / \$1,000					
COST LINE	STATUS	ADP	INSUPERITY (SAVER)	TRINET / AETNA	ANGLE
Medical — contribution floor	REQUIRED	\$8,977	\$24,468	\$12,936	\$10,537
Medical — our spend above floor	OPTIONAL	\$25,823	\$12,849	\$21,864	\$24,263
Admin / service fee	REQUIRED	\$10,072 1.53% of payroll	\$10,980 \$183 PEPM	\$14,400 \$1,200/mo minimum — see note	— none disclosed
Workers' comp EPLI included at all three	REQUIRED	\$0 inside the 1.53% fee	~\$994 estimated — see note	\$300 confirmed by TriNet	OWN POLICY NEEDED
Dental + vision	OPTIONAL REQ AT INSUPERITY	\$0 "can be employee all paid"	\$1,320 \$27.50 PEPM minimum × 4	\$0 no funding required	NOT OFFERED
Basic life & AD&D	OPT AT ADP REQ AT TRINET	\$72 elective — ADP confirmed	NOT QUOTED	\$67 "\$10,000 required"	NOT OFFERED
Long-term disability	OPTIONAL	\$137 elective — ADP confirmed	NOT QUOTED	\$625 confirmed not required — our choice	NOT OFFERED
One-time setup	REQUIRED	\$1,900	\$2,825	\$1,375	NOT DISCLOSED
Year 1 as modeled		\$46,981	\$53,436	\$51,567	\$34,800
Year 1 stripped to required only		\$20,949	\$40,588	\$29,078	\$10,537

- **Angle's total is not a like-for-like comparison.** It is medical only. To stand next to the PEO columns it still needs standalone dental/vision, life, LTD, workers' compensation, and payroll/HR/EPLI, plus a setup fee nobody has quoted. Those rows are blank because the product doesn't include them — not because they are free. One piece of that gap is already a real, known cost: **Onyx pays for outside HR support today**, which all three PEOs absorb and Angle does not. That figure belongs in this comparison once we have it.
- **Insuperity's floor alone (\$24,468) exceeds ADP's entire required year-one cost (\$20,949).** That gap is structural — a 75% funding rule against a more expensive menu — and no contribution decision on our side closes it.
- **TriNet is the only vendor that requires employer-paid life insurance** — its own worksheet reads "\$10,000 required." **ADP has confirmed that its basic life and LTD are elective.** Both lines are kept in the total because our benefit design calls for employer-paid life and long-term disability, but dropping them would take **\$209** off ADP's year one, bringing it to \$46,772.
- **Insuperity is the only vendor that makes us fund dental and vision.** Its **\$27.50 per employee per month is a minimum**, not a modeling choice — \$1,320/yr assuming all four medical enrollees opt in. ADP states outright that both "can be employee all paid," and TriNet requires no funding either, so at both we can offer the benefit at **\$0** and let employees fund it. Funding it voluntarily at ADP or TriNet would cost the same \$1,320, roughly 38% of the underlying premium (\$3,502 at ADP, \$3,467 at TriNet).
- **Insuperity applies a floor to ancillary benefits too, not just medical.** A 75% floor on medical and a \$27.50 floor on dental/vision. ADP and TriNet impose neither — we set the ancillary contribution at whatever we choose, including nothing.
- **The \$1,320 is settled at four opt-ins.** Insuperity's benefit sheet allows dental and vision to be elected independently of medical, so a fifth participant would have raised the minimum to \$1,650 — but Josephine is declining dental and vision as well as medical.
- **Insuperity's workers' comp is an estimate, not a quote.** Its bid allocates \$938.52 across the wrong census; re-rating it for Jessica in place of Elena, using the base-plus-rate pattern implied by its own per-employee figures, gives roughly \$994. Ask for the actual rates.
- **Settled: TriNet's fee is the \$1,200/month minimum, confirmed directly.** Their own paperwork stated it two ways — the fee table in the Executive Summary and the proposal deck printed an Annual Total of \$11,160 (5 × \$186 PEPM), with the minimum appearing only as an asterisk, while their VROI model used \$14,400. TriNet has now confirmed the minimum applies. **\$14,400 stands, and the one variable that could have closed ADP's lead did not.** Had it been waived, TriNet's year one would have fallen to \$48,327 and the gap to \$1,346.
- **Also settled by TriNet, in the same conversation:** the contribution floor is **70% of the lowest-cost plan we offer**, which confirms our derivation and holds it at **\$269.50**; workers' compensation is **\$300**, not the \$324 we re-rated; basic life at \$10,000 is **\$67**; and **nothing else is required** — no dental, no vision, and long-term disability is optional. The \$625 LTD line stays in the total only because our own benefit design calls for it. Dropping LTD would take TriNet's year one to **\$50,942** and ADP's to \$46,844 if we dropped it there too.
- **Our effective rate is \$240 per employee per month, not the quoted \$186** — the minimum spreads \$1,200 across five people, a 29% premium over the headline number. It self-clears at seven employees, but that does not help: the fee then rises to \$15,624.
- **The fee structures behave differently as we grow.** ADP's floats with payroll, so raises and bonuses raise it. Insuperity's is flat per head. TriNet's is a floor we sit under until a seventh hire.

The renewal reverses Angle's advantage

Compared at the same deductible on total medical premium. ADP and TriNet publish a 10% trend assumption; Insperity's one-year agreements state none, so 10% is our assumption. Angle claims renewals land under 10% — we are modeling your 40% expectation instead.

Total medical premium, year 1 to year 2 at actual enrollment				
PLAN	DEDUCTIBLE	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	TREND APPLIED
Angle HDHP 3400/5000	\$3,400	\$48,996	\$68,594	+40% — your estimate
ADP Aetna EPO HDHP 3500	\$3,500	\$54,991	\$60,490	+10% — ADP stated
TriNet Aetna HDHP 4000	\$4,000	\$55,488	\$61,037	+10% — TriNet VROI
Insperity UHC 3400 HDHP (Saver base plan)	\$3,400	\$75,911	\$83,502	+10% — our assumption
Insperity UHC 3000 Primary Advantage	\$3,000	\$71,826	\$79,009	+10% — our assumption

- A \$6,000 advantage becomes an \$8,000 disadvantage in a single renewal. This is the only place the ranking actually turns.
- Two features compound the risk: Angle can re-rate on a greater-than-10% enrollment swing, and at four subscribers one hire or departure is a 25% change. Its stop loss is aggregate-only — there is no individual-claimant layer, so a single large claim is absorbed inside our own funded amount before the carrier responds. That is precisely the mechanism that produces a 40% renewal.
- Insperity ranks fourth on premium regardless of trend. Even after Angle's 40% renewal, Insperity's year two still runs roughly \$10,400 higher than Angle's worst case.
- Insperity now has an exact match. Its Independence Saver package carries a 3400 HDHP — the same deductible as Angle's base plan — at \$75,911, or \$26,915 more than Angle for identical deductible exposure.

The renewal date matters as much as the percentage

The table above compares 12-month blocks. That is not how all four vendors work. A plan year fixed to the carrier's calendar rather than to our October 1 start means the first increase arrives early — and a second one lands inside 24 months. All four dates are now confirmed directly with the vendors.

VENDOR	PLAN YEAR	FIRST YEAR	BASIS
ADP	Renews 6/1/2027	8 months	Documented — "Renewal Info 6/1/2027" on every plan card; VSP resets 6/1
Angle	Renews 10/1/2027	12 months	Documented — "rates guaranteed for the 12-month contract period"
Insperity	Renews 10/1/2027	12 months	Confirmed by Insperity — "we extend anniversary date renewals, so 12 months from your effective date." Our earlier read of the "(1750 in 2027)" plan labels as a calendar plan year was wrong; those are IRS deductible steps applied at the plan's own renewal.
TriNet	Renews 10/1/2027	12 months	Confirmed by TriNet — renewals fall on "the 1st month of the quarter in which you start," so a 10/1 start holds 10/1 in perpetuity. Quarter-anchored, not anniversary-anchored: an 11/1 start would renew 10/1/2027, giving only 11 months.

- All four plan years are now confirmed, and ADP is the only one that does not give us a full first year. Over 24 months at the matched deductible: TriNet \$116,525 · Angle \$117,590 · ADP \$119,331 · Insperity \$159,412. ADP is the only vendor absorbing two increases in that window — which is why it lands behind Angle over two years despite Angle taking a 40% renewal.
- Protecting the October 1 date matters most for TriNet. Its renewal is anchored to the quarter we start in, not to our anniversary. Starting 10/1 locks 10/1 permanently; slipping to 11/1 would give a first plan year of only 11 months and pull the first increase forward.
- A renewal lands mostly on employees, not on Onyx. Because our contribution is a fixed dollar amount per tier, premium increases flow to payroll deductions. Angle's 40% renewal is the sharpest case: total premium rises \$19,598, of which Onyx absorbs \$88 and employees absorb \$19,511 — their combined cost goes from \$14,196 to \$33,707.
- The one channel that can raise Onyx's cost at renewal is the floor, since it is a percentage of a rate that rises. After a 40% Angle renewal the floor reaches \$307.32 and, for the first time, exceeds our \$300 employee-only target. TriNet's floor lands at \$296.45 after 10% — just under. Insperity's rises to \$560.74, widening the override on Lisa.

What each plan costs our people

Coinsurance is shown as the share *the plan* pays after the deductible; office-visit, pharmacy and emergency-room figures are what *the member* pays.

Reading the employee columns. Each cell shows the monthly payroll deduction, then the annual total broken into its two parts: **premium** (twelve months of deductions) and **care** (the household's out-of-pocket maximum). These are separate pots of money — an out-of-pocket maximum caps what you pay for treatment and *never* includes premiums — so they add without overlapping. That is why a total can run two or three times the out-of-pocket maximum: on the richer plans the premium is the larger half. Christine on ADP's OA MC 1000 pays \$12,620 in premium against a \$9,000 care cap; for Steven or Jessica on that plan premium is 65% of the total.

ADP TotalSource — Aetna curated lineup of 4 · floor \$187.02 · Onyx \$34,800/yr										
PLAN	DED IND / FAM	OOP IND / FAM	COINS (PLAN PAYS)	PCP / SPEC	RX 1/2/3	ER	LISA	CHRISTINE	STEVEN & JESSICA (EA.)	
EPO 8000 ValueNT FLOOR-SETTER — NOT HSA-ELIGIBLE	\$8,000 / \$16,000	\$10,000 / \$20,000	80%	\$10 / \$110	\$10 / \$50 ^d / \$90 ^d	ded+20%	\$74/mo \$888 premium + \$10,000 care = \$10,888	\$204/mo \$2,450 premium + \$20,000 care = \$22,450	\$160/mo \$1,914 premium + \$20,000 care = \$21,914	
EPO HDHP 3500-80% HSA	\$3,500 / \$7,000	\$6,350 / \$12,700	80%	20% ^d	\$10 ^d / \$45 ^d / \$70 ^d	ded+20%	\$190/mo \$2,281 premium + \$6,350 care = \$8,631	\$454/mo \$5,445 premium + \$12,700 care = \$18,145	\$519/mo \$6,232 premium + \$12,700 care = \$18,932	
EPO HDHP 2500-100Coplay HSA BEST PROTECTION FOR LISA AND CHRISTINE	\$2,500 / \$5,000	\$3,500 / \$7,000	100%	\$30 ^d / \$60 ^d	\$10 ^d / \$45 ^d / \$70 ^d	ded+\$350	\$307/mo \$3,682 premium + \$3,500 care = \$7,182	\$705/mo \$8,457 premium + \$7,000 care = \$15,457	\$881/mo \$10,575 premium + \$7,000 care = \$17,575	
NATIONAL OA MC 1000-80% ONLY LINEUP PLAN WITH OUT-OF-NETWORK	\$1,000 / \$2,000	\$4,500 / \$9,000	80%	\$25 / \$50	\$10 / \$45 / \$70	\$500	\$468/mo \$5,619 premium + \$4,500 care = \$10,119	\$1,052/mo \$12,620 premium + \$9,000 care = \$21,620	\$1,381/mo \$16,578 premium + \$9,000 care = \$25,578	

TriNet — Aetna 4 rungs of 12 offered · floor \$269.50 · Onyx \$34,800/yr										
PLAN	DED IND / FAM	OOP IND / FAM	COINS (PLAN PAYS)	PCP / SPEC	RX 1/2/3	ER	LISA	CHRISTINE	STEVEN & JESSICA (EA.)	
Aetna ACO 6500 AZ BANNER NETWORK ONLY — FLOOR-SETTER	\$6,500 / \$13,000	\$7,500 / \$15,000	100%	\$25 / \$65	\$10 / \$45 / \$80	0% ^d	\$85/mo \$1,020 premium + \$7,500 care = \$8,520	\$289/mo \$3,468 premium + \$15,000 care = \$18,468	\$166/mo \$1,992 premium + \$15,000 care = \$16,992	
Aetna HDHP 4000 HSA	\$4,000 / \$8,000	\$6,850 / \$13,700	80%	20% ^d	\$10 ^d / \$45 ^d / \$70 ^d	20% ^d	\$194/mo \$2,328 premium + \$6,850 care = \$9,178	\$540/mo \$6,480 premium + \$13,700 care = \$20,180	\$495/mo \$5,940 premium + \$13,700 care = \$19,640	
Aetna PPO 2000	\$2,000 / \$4,000	\$6,850 / \$13,700	80%	\$30 / \$60	\$10 / \$45 / \$70	\$500	\$332/mo \$3,984 premium + \$6,850 care = \$10,834	\$860/mo \$10,320 premium + \$13,700 care = \$24,020	\$915/mo \$10,980 premium + \$13,700 care = \$24,680	
Aetna PPO 750 RICHEST RUNG SHOWN	\$750 / \$1,500	\$4,000 / \$8,000	90%	\$25 / \$50	\$10 / \$45 / \$70	\$350	\$443/mo \$5,316 premium + \$4,000 care = \$9,316	\$1,117/mo \$13,404 premium + \$8,000 care = \$21,404	\$1,252/mo \$15,024 premium + \$8,000 care = \$23,024	

Insperity — Independence Saver UnitedHealthcare · all 7 rungs offered · floor \$509.76 · Onyx \$37,317/yr										
PLAN	DED IND / FAM	OOP IND / FAM	COINS (PLAN PAYS)	PCP / SPEC	RX 1/2/3	ER	LISA	CHRISTINE	STEVEN & JESSICA (EA.)	
UHC 6500 Primary Advantage CHEAPEST IN EITHER PACKAGE	\$6,500 / \$13,000	\$9,200 / \$18,400	100%	\$0 / \$100	\$5 / \$50 / \$100	\$250+ded	\$94/mo \$1,126 premium + \$9,200 care = \$10,326	\$667/mo \$8,009 premium + \$18,400 care = \$26,409	\$871/mo \$10,456 premium + \$18,400 care = \$28,856	
UHC 5000 HDHP HSA	\$5,000 / \$10,000	\$7,150 / \$14,300	80%	20% ^d	\$10 ^d / \$35 ^d / \$60 ^d	20% ^d	\$108/mo \$1,292 premium + \$7,150 care = \$8,442	\$694/mo \$8,322 premium + \$14,300 care = \$22,622	\$914/mo \$10,963 premium + \$14,300 care = \$25,263	
UHC 3000 Primary Advantage BEST VALUE ON THE MENU	\$3,000 / \$6,000	\$6,500 / \$13,000	80%	\$0 / \$100	\$5 / \$50 / \$100	\$250+ded+20%	\$135/mo \$1,615 premium + \$6,500 care = \$8,115	\$751/mo \$9,014 premium + \$13,000 care = \$22,014	\$995/mo \$11,940 premium + \$13,000 care = \$24,940	
UHC 3400 HDHP HSA BASE PLAN – SETS THE \$509.76 FLOOR	\$3,400 / \$6,800	\$7,000 / \$14,000	90%	10% ^d	\$10 ^d / \$35 ^d / \$60 ^d	10% ^d	\$170/mo \$2,039 premium + \$7,000 care = \$9,039	\$826/mo \$9,908 premium + \$14,000 care = \$23,908	\$1,110/mo \$13,323 premium + \$14,000 care = \$27,323	
UHC 4000 Choice Plus WORST FAMILY EXPOSURE IN THE FIELD	\$4,000 / \$8,000	\$8,500 / \$17,000	100%	\$35 / \$65	\$10 / \$45 / \$70	\$500	\$242/mo \$2,906 premium + \$8,500 care = \$11,406	\$974/mo \$11,688 premium + \$17,000 care = \$28,688	\$1,323/mo \$15,877 premium + \$17,000 care = \$32,877	
UHC 1700 HDHP HSA BEST PROTECTION ON THE MENU	\$1,700 / \$3,400	\$4,500 / \$9,000	90%	10% ^d	\$10 ^d / \$35 ^d / \$60 ^d	10% ^d	\$314/mo \$3,772 premium + \$4,500 care = \$8,272	\$1,131/mo \$13,578 premium + \$9,000 care = \$22,578	\$1,550/mo \$18,597 premium + \$9,000 care = \$27,597	
UHC 1000 Choice Plus RICHEST RUNG	\$1,000 / \$3,000	\$5,000 / \$10,000	80%	\$35 / \$65	\$10 / \$40 / \$65	\$250	\$338/mo \$4,058 premium + \$5,000 care = \$9,058	\$1,179/mo \$14,149 premium + \$10,000 care = \$24,149	\$1,624/mo \$19,491 premium + \$10,000 care = \$29,491	

- **One Insperity cost the table does not show:** its Choice Plus and Primary Advantage options carry a **separate prescription deductible** — \$150 to \$250 per individual, \$450 to \$600 per family — before pharmacy copays begin. On the Primary Advantage plans it applies to Tiers 3 and 4 only; on Choice Plus the Benefits At A Glance does not specify which tiers. No other vendor's plans here carry a separate Rx deductible.
- **Insperity's plan designs are now fully documented** — all seven Saver rungs, from its own Benefits At A Glance. Nothing in this table is inferred.
- **Its ladder is worse than it looks at the low end.** The 6500 Primary Advantage carries a **\$9,200 individual and \$18,400 family** out-of-pocket maximum, and the 4000 Choice Plus carries **\$8,500 / \$17,000** — the highest family exposure of any plan in the field, ADP's \$8,000-deductible plan included.
- **Its best plan is genuinely good and genuinely expensive.** The 1700 HDHP caps a member at \$4,500 and a family at \$9,000, but costs Christine \$1,131/mo and each family \$1,550/mo after Onyx's contribution — roughly double what Angle's richest plan costs them.
- **Choosing Select instead would cost Onyx \$2,208 more a year.** Its base plan is the 2000 Deductible, so the floor rises to \$646.90 and overrides *both* Lisa's \$300 and Christine's \$600 — \$39,526 against Saver's \$37,317.

Angle Health — level funded, Cigna PPO network all 3 plans · floor \$219.52 · Onyx \$34,800/yr										
PLAN	DED IND / FAM	OOP IND / FAM	COINS (PLAN PAYS)	PCP / SPEC	RX 1/2	ER	LISA	CHRISTINE	STEVEN & JESSICA (EA.)	
ANG HDHP 3400/5000 HSA CAPFI'S RECOMMENDED BASE PLAN	\$3,400 / \$6,800	\$5,000 / \$10,000	80%	20% ^d	20% ^d	20% ^d	\$139/mo \$1,668 premium + \$5,000 care = \$6,668	\$322/mo \$3,864 premium + \$10,000 care = \$13,864	\$361/mo \$4,332 premium + \$10,000 care = \$14,332	
ANG TRAD 2000/4000 TIER RATES DERIVED – CONFIRM WITH CAPFI	\$2,000 / \$4,000	\$4,000 / \$8,000	80%	\$20 / \$50	\$20 / \$60	\$250	\$192/mo \$2,305 premium + \$4,000 care = \$6,305	\$433/mo \$5,201 premium + \$8,000 care = \$13,201	\$526/mo \$6,306 premium + \$8,000 care = \$14,306	
ANG TRAD 1000/2000 BEST DESIGN IN THE FIELD	\$1,000 / \$2,000	\$2,000 / \$4,000	80%	\$10 / \$30	\$10 / \$30	\$200	\$246/mo \$2,956 premium + \$2,000 care = \$4,956	\$547/mo \$6,567 premium + \$4,000 care = \$10,567	\$694/mo \$8,323 premium + \$4,000 care = \$12,323	

No single PEO is best for everyone

ADP leads on employer cost and holds the lowest payroll deduction for all three households — but that is its 8000 ValueNT, which carries the field's worst individual exposure and no HSA. Judged on what each household would actually elect, the answer splits.

HOUSEHOLD	LOWEST WORST-CASE EXPOSURE	BEST VALUE
Lisa employee only	ADP HDHP 2500-100Coplay \$307/mo · worst \$7,182	Insp erity 3000 Primary Advantage \$135/mo · worst \$8,115 — \$2,067/yr less for \$933 more exposure
Christine employee + spouse	ADP HDHP 2500-100Coplay \$705/mo · worst \$15,457	TriNet ACO 6500 \$289/mo · worst \$18,468
Steven & Jessica family	TriNet ACO 6500 \$166/mo · worst \$16,992	TriNet ACO 6500 wins on both axes

- **For the two family tiers, TriNet's ACO 6500 is the best plan in the PEO field on both axes** — \$166/mo, within \$6 of ADP's cheapest plan, and a worst case \$583 below ADP's best. That single plan is the strongest argument against treating ADP as best for everyone.
- **ADP is decisively best for Christine.** Its 2500-100Coplay caps her household at \$15,457; TriNet's best for her is \$18,468 and Insp erity's is \$22,014 — \$6,557 worse.
- **Insp erity is best for exactly one person.** Lisa's 3000 Primary Advantage is genuinely good value, but only because Onyx is forced to overpay \$209.76/month on her behalf. That is the floor working in her favor and against Onyx.
- **Two caveats before anyone elects the ACO 6500.** It sits on **Banner Health Network only**, so provider access is narrower than the rest of TriNet's menu. And worst case is not a typical year: it carries a **\$13,000 family deductible** with office copays before the deductible and 100% coverage after, while ADP's 2500-100Coplay has a \$5,000 family deductible but applies it to office visits. The ACO 6500 is better for routine care and for a catastrophic year; ADP's plan is better through the middle.

- **Lowest deduction is not lowest risk.** Lisa pays \$74/mo on ADP's 8000 ValueNT but carries \$10,888 of exposure. On Angle's TRAD 2000/4000 she pays \$192 and her exposure drops to \$6,305 — \$4,583 less risk for \$1,417 more premium.
- **Angle's richest plan costs a family \$694/mo** — less than what all three PEOs charge for mid-tier coverage, with a \$1,000 deductible instead of \$2,500–\$5,000.
- **Insp erity's low-end number is an illusion.** Lisa's \$108/mo looks competitive only because the floor forces Onyx to overpay \$209.76/month on her behalf, and it buys her a \$5,000-deductible plan. Christine and both families pay the highest deductions in the field on that same plan.
- **HSAs are noted, not modeled — by choice.** The [HSA] tag marks which plans are HSA-qualified and changes no figure in this report. Worst case is 12 months of payroll deductions plus the household out-of-pocket maximum, with no employer seed, no employee contribution and no credit for the tax deduction on HSA dollars. We cannot know what any individual will choose to contribute, and building an assumption about that into the numbers would hide the guess rather than remove it. The effect is that these figures **overstate the true cost of the HDHP options** relative to the copay plans, since HDHP spending can be funded pre-tax and copay-plan spending cannot. Two things worth knowing when reading the HDHP rows: ADP's 8000 ValueNT is **not** HSA-eligible — it pays \$10 primary-care and Tier 1 copays before the deductible — so its \$10,000 exposure has no pre-tax offset at all; and on every plan here the family out-of-pocket maximum exceeds one year's HSA contribution limit, so the offset is partial in year one and depends on accumulated balance.
- **Out-of-network is ADP's one structural weakness** — nine of its eleven plans cover nothing out of network. We have judged this immaterial: no out-of-state work travel, and Arizona has adequate in-network access. One national plan is kept in the lineup regardless.

The right plan for each person

Lisa Danforth \$178,094 · Employee only Highest-paid non-owner	BEST OVERALL	Angle TRAD 2000/4000 — \$192/mo, worst case \$6,305. Lowest risk-adjusted cost available to her.
	BEST AT A PEO	ADP EPO HDHP 3500 — \$190/mo, essentially the same premium as Angle, but \$2,326 more exposure. For real protection, ADP EPO HDHP 2500-100Coplay at \$307/mo caps her at \$7,182 and pays 100% after deductible.
	AVOID	ADP 8000 ValueNT despite the \$74/mo. It belongs on the menu to hold our floor at \$187.02 — not on her enrollment form.
	With no dependents and the highest non-owner salary, an HSA-qualified plan is worth more to Lisa than to anyone else — her deduction lands at the top marginal rate. She is also the reason Insperty's floor bites: her \$300 tier is forced to \$509.76, costing Onyx \$2,517 a year for a \$5,000-deductible plan.	
Christine Johnson \$79,228 · Employee + spouse Affordability pressure point	BEST OVERALL	Angle HDHP 3400/5000 — \$322/mo, or 4.9% of gross pay .
	BEST AT A PEO	ADP EPO HDHP 3500 — \$454/mo, 6.9% of pay. TriNet's closest is 8.2%; Insperty's cheapest plan is 10.5% .
	CONSIDER	Raising the employee+spouse contribution from \$600 to roughly \$678 — about \$930 a year — to bring her subsidy in line with the family tier.
Steven Nikolov \$186,000 · Family 100% owner · S-corp	BEST OVERALL	Angle TRAD 1000/2000 — \$694/mo, worst case \$12,323. The lowest family exposure anywhere in the field.
	BEST AT A PEO	ADP EPO HDHP 2500-100Coplay — \$881/mo, worst case \$17,575. The best family protection any PEO offers.
	NEW AT TRINET	TriNet allows different funding tiers by class , so Onyx could fund 100% of your premium while holding everyone else at the fixed dollars. On the ACO 6500 that costs Onyx \$1,992 more a year ; on its richest plan, \$19,368. It buys you no tax advantage — see below — and we have not confirmed whether ADP permits the same structure.
	TAX NOTE	Under IRC §1372 , as a greater-than-2% shareholder you cannot run premiums pretax through the cafeteria plan.
Jessica B. \$135,000 · Family New hire	BEST OVERALL	Angle HDHP 3400/5000 at \$361/mo for the lowest deduction, or TRAD 1000/2000 at \$694/mo for the best protection her family can buy.
	BEST AT A PEO	ADP EPO HDHP 3500 at \$519/mo, or 2500-100Coplay at \$881/mo.
	RESOLVED AT TRINET	TriNet has confirmed the new-hire waiting period is ours to set, including none — so a 10/1 effective date for her is achievable there. Still unconfirmed at ADP and Insperty.
	Her enrollment runs fully pretax. Same tier and same rates as Steven — but her effective cost is lower than his for the identical plan , since she keeps the payroll-tax advantage he cannot use.	
Josephine Mack \$80,000 · Waives medical, dental and vision Covered for life & LTD	ACTION	A signed waiver needs to be on file before the effective date.
	IF SHE ENROLLS	It would be family coverage, so Onyx cost rises \$12,000/yr — the same at all four vendors, since no floor reaches the \$1,000 family tier.
	She is included in employer-paid life and LTD, which is why those lines cover five employees rather than four. Two consequences worth flagging on the Angle option: adding a fifth subscriber is a 25% enrollment change , which exceeds the 10% swing that lets Angle re-rate mid-term — and a family enrollment adds several covered lives to a six-member level-funded pool, which is a materially bigger underwriting change than one more single employee.	

What else each PEO brings

Angle is excluded here — it sells medical only, so there is nothing to compare. Every entry below comes from what the vendor actually put in writing. *Not documented* means the vendor may well offer it but has not said so in anything we hold.

Relevance is judged against Onyx as it is: five employees, one state, an office with no meaningful OSHA exposure, a CPA firm, and a prospective TriNet referral partner.

Non-medical capabilities from vendor documents only				
CAPABILITY	TRINET	ADP TOTALSOURCE	INSPERITY	RELEVANCE TO ONYX
RISK AND COMPLIANCE				
EPLI	\$1,000,000 stated	included, limit not stated	bundled with WC, limit not stated	High
Workers' compensation	0.044 / 0.087 rates disclosed	folded into service fee	bundled, \$939 allocation	Low — office exposure
Outside employment counsel	Fisher Phillips at negotiated rates ; hotline included	HR Investigation Team	NOT DOCUMENTED	Medium
Handbook and policy review	included	included — ADP confirmed	NOT DOCUMENTED	Medium — handbook already in place
Accreditation	ESAC; 30-yr public company	NOT STATED	IRS-certified CPEO	Medium
SERVICE MODEL				
Named service roles	employee specialists, 24/7 chat	8 named roles — HR BP, Payroll BP, Risk & Safety, Benefits, Investigations, Tax, WC Claims, MyLife	one designated HR specialist	High — displaces paid outside HR support
Claims and billing advocacy	NOT DOCUMENTED	Health Advocate	NOT DOCUMENTED	High — HDHP-heavy menus
TECHNOLOGY				
IT support	Electric — basic tier included, upgrades unpriced	none offered	NOT DOCUMENTED	See note below
Expense management	TriNetExpense — T&E only , QBO integration	NOT DOCUMENTED	NOT DOCUMENTED	Low — does not replace AP
Time and attendance	TriNetTime	NOT DOCUMENTED	NOT DOCUMENTED	None — keeping Harvest
Applicant tracking / postings	TriNetHire — unlimited jobs, Indeed, Glassdoor, Monster	job postings	recruiting claimed, no detail	Medium
Performance management	TriNetPerform + DocuSign	NOT DOCUMENTED	claimed, no detail	Low at five people
Learning and training	TriNetLearn; harassment and HR 101 training	Learning Academy (payroll, tax, comp, HR analytics certifications) + Workforce Now LMS — <i>inclusion unconfirmed</i>	training claimed, no detail	High — administrator development
Document mgmt / certification tracking	Box-backed, certification tracking	LMS compliance tracking	NOT DOCUMENTED	Medium — CPE tracking
Accounting integrations	QuickBooks Online, Xero, Intacct, NetSuite	ADP Marketplace catalog	NOT DOCUMENTED	High — CPA firm
EMPLOYEE EXPERIENCE				
Discount marketplace	TriNet Perks — thousands of national and local deals: gym, phone carriers, travel, tickets, auto, technology. Onyx can post its own offers.	real-estate discount only — no marketplace	NOT DOCUMENTED	Medium
Voluntary insurance shelf	pet, legal, commuter, disability, EAP	widest — hospital indemnity, critical illness, accident, group legal, auto/home, pet, ID theft, term life, AD&D	dental and vision only in file	High — patches HDHP gaps
Benefits decision support	Healthee — fee waived	NOT DOCUMENTED	NOT DOCUMENTED	High — 16-plan menu
Total compensation statements	included	NOT DOCUMENTED	NOT DOCUMENTED	High — \$8,700/person unseen
Compensation benchmarking	included with workforce analytics	reporting and analytics	workforce reporting	Medium

Not applicable at five employees

Several headline inclusions carry no internal value for Onyx as it stands: **EEO-1 reporting** (not required below 100 employees), **multi-state PTO guidance** (Arizona only), **international hiring and contractor payments**, the **401(k) annual independent audit** (not required under 100 participants), and **DEI workshops for supervisors**. TriNet's proposal also sells an "industry specific solution tailored for nonprofits" and expense tagging to "grants or programs" — recycled content that does not describe Onyx.

One qualification: TriNet is pitching Onyx as a **referral partner**, so its full catalog has business-development value even where it has no internal use. That is revenue-side, and deliberately excluded from the cost tables.

The structure of that partnership is not a detail. TriNet has offered it two ways: money paid back to Onyx, or a discount passed to the client. Money back to Onyx is a **referral fee**, and for a CPA firm that engages the AICPA Code of Professional Conduct — commissions and referral fees are **prohibited** from any client for whom we perform an audit, review, or a compilation where we are not independent, and **permitted only with written disclosure** to every other client. The Arizona State Board may impose more.

The client-discount version avoids all of it and still makes the referral worth making. Confirm the rule before agreeing to a structure, not after.

Why IT support is not credited to TriNet

- **There is no current spend to offset.** Onyx pays nothing for IT today, so Electric reduces a future cost we have not committed to — it is not a saving against ADP.
- **The tier that solves the problem is the priced one.** Electric's basic plan is not expected to be sufficient, and upgrade pricing is still open. That is simply buying IT support, which can be bought from anyone.
- **It couples two decisions that should stay separate.** Leaving TriNet later would also mean re-contracting IT.
- **Security requirements should drive that choice.** As a tax preparer Onyx falls under the FTC Safeguards Rule and needs a written information security plan per IRS Pub 4557. Whether a provider supports that matters more than whether it is bundled with payroll. *Confirm the basic tier even qualifies before treating it as a benefit.*

401(k): ADP is the cheapest to run and the only one fully documented

401(k) comparison modeled at 5 participants			
ITEM	TRINET – EMPOWER	INSPERITY – GOLDMAN SACHS AM	ADP
Structure	Multiple employer plan; TriNet is sponsor and 3(16) administrator, with a 3(21) investment fiduciary	Insperity is sponsor and secures the trustee; GSAM selects and monitors investments	Multiple employer plan; ADP is sponsor and 3(16) administrator, recordkept by Voya . ADP TotalSource holds investment oversight — 3(38) status is not stated
Employer setup	\$0	\$600 startup / \$1,000 takeover	\$0
Employer recurring	\$0	\$50/mo base + \$3 per participant = \$780/yr	\$0
Participant fee	\$5.25/mo — \$63/yr	\$3.50/mo — \$42/yr	none — recordkeeping is \$49/participant paid by the plan out of a 0.22% credit inside fund expenses, not deducted from accounts
Exit fee	\$1,000	\$1,200	none disclosed
Fund expense ratios	"0.14% average" — lineup not disclosed	fully disclosed — target-date 0.06%, S&P 500 index 0.01%, active 0.30–0.80%	fully disclosed — target-date 0.48% all-in, Russell 3000 index 0.23%, US debt index 0.25%, ACWI ex-US 0.28%, active 0.48–0.91%
Watch for	\$150/hour for match, profit-sharing and true-up allocations; \$150 per amendment	\$500 per additional compliance test; \$400 per extra asset transfer	Self-directed brokerage \$100/yr + 0.22% of balance; managed accounts 0.45% under \$100k; QDRO \$450
Recordkeeper	Empower	Goldman Sachs Asset Management	Voya — top 5 by participants, same tier as Empower
Evidence quality	sales flyer, fees as of 01/2025	fee schedule	DOL §404a-5 participant disclosure dated 6/30/2026
Explicit recurring fees, 5 participants	\$315/yr, all on participants	\$990/yr, \$780 of it on Onyx	\$0 — charged through expense ratios instead

- **ADP charges Onyx nothing and charges participants no account fee either.** Plan administration is funded by a **0.22% credit inside every fund's expense ratio** — so participants do pay for it, but in proportion to their balance rather than as a flat charge that falls hardest on the smallest accounts. Recordkeeping is \$49 per participant, paid by the plan out of that credit.
- **Correction to an earlier read: TriNet does not cost Onyx nothing.** No setup and no maintenance fee, but **\$1,000 to terminate, \$150 per amendment, and \$150 per hour for match, profit-sharing and true-up allocations** — work an owner-heavy S-corp plan would need every year. ADP discloses no employer charge of any kind.
- **TriNet's expense-ratio claim now reduces to one number.** A 0.14% menu average is implausible for a lineup carrying American Funds and PIMCO. Against ADP's documented 0.48% target-date, the crossover sits near **\$18,500** of account balance if 0.14% is real — but if TriNet's target-date is nearer 0.35%, the two are even at a \$50,000 balance. Ask for the target-date expense ratio, not the lineup.
- **Insperity's 0.06% target-date still wins at scale, and it takes longer to matter than it looks.** It beats ADP's 0.48% on the fund, but Insperity bills Onyx \$780 a year. Run both at five participants and **ADP is cheaper until average balances reach roughly \$47,000** — years away for a new plan, unless Steven and Lisa roll existing balances in, which would get there quickly.
- **An October 1 TriNet 401(k) start is not achievable.** Their process needs roughly 45 days from the installation kit, documents signed about 30 days before the effective date, and adoption only on the first of a month. Earliest realistic date is **November 1**, so retirement will lag medical by at least a month.
- **SECURE 2.0 credits are worth up to \$5,000/yr for three years**, plus \$500/yr for automatic enrollment and up to \$1,000 per employee for employer contributions. But ADP and TriNet are both **multiple employer plans with the PEO as plan sponsor**, and neither has said whether an adopting employer still claims them. Not vendor-independent after all — put the question to both vendors and the tax preparer.

VALUE VERDICT

ADP on value, and the margin is wider than the soft benefits can close.

TriNet has the deepest documented catalog and four capabilities nobody else offers — Perks, Total Comp Statements, Healthee and TriNetExpense. The fifth, \$0 employer 401(k) cost, is no longer exclusive: **ADP matches it and adds no participant account fee**, so the retirement line no longer narrows ADP's lead. **ADP is \$4,586 a year cheaper with better plan designs**, and that figure now stands without a 401(k) caveat and without a fee caveat — TriNet has confirmed the \$1,200 monthly minimum applies. Once IT support is set aside — it is new money either way — TriNet's remaining edge is real but unpriced convenience, not cost. Insperity finishes third: category parity on services, worst coverage, highest floor, and the only 401(k) that bills the employer.

How these numbers were built

Every bid was re-rated

- **No vendor priced Onyx's actual group.** TriNet and Insperity both quoted Elena Nikolov at \$41,600 with Jessica absent, on \$564,922 of payroll. Angle priced three employee-only and one family, six members. ADP used \$628,680 of payroll against our actual \$658,322.
- Every figure here was **re-priced by us** to actual enrollment — Lisa employee-only, Christine employee+spouse, Steven and Jessica family, Josephine waiving — using each vendor's published tier rates.
- **The model validates against source.** It reproduces Insperity's own published employee contributions to the penny: \$107.68 on the 5000 HDHP and \$134.58 on the 3000 Primary Advantage.

Known gaps, carried not filled

- **Insperity's life and LTD rates were never quoted.** Its employer cost is therefore understated. Its medical plan designs, by contrast, are now complete — all seven Saver rungs come from its own Benefits At A Glance.
- **Angle discloses no broker or consulting fee.** Its "21% administration" line is the third-party administrator's cost inside the premium, not a fee billed to Onyx. CapFi's own compensation is not stated anywhere in the presentation.
- **Angle's TRAD 2000/4000 tier rates are derived** from the ratios in its two documented plans, which reproduce both exactly. Confirm before quoting to employees.
- **TriNet's contribution floor was our derivation and TriNet has now confirmed it** — 70% of the minimum funding on the lowest-cost plan offered. Our figure of **\$269.50** stands, keyed to the ACO 6500's \$385 employee-only rate. One thing to verify: TriNet now says **twelve** plans are available, where the strategy appendix we were given lists sixteen Aetna rungs. If the ACO 6500 is not among the twelve, the floor rises — dropping only the four cheapest would push it to \$364.00 and above our \$300 employee-only target.
- **Insperity's floor mechanic is now confirmed in writing** and it is not what any of the earlier quotes implied. The floor is **75% of the employee-only rate of each package's designated base plan** — the 3400 HDHP under Saver (\$679.68 → \$509.76) and the 2000 Deductible under Select (\$862.53 → \$646.90) — not 75% of the cheapest plan offered. Insperity also caps the employer contribution at 100% of the elected plan's premium, which is why a floor above a plan's full cost is not the impossibility it first appeared to be.

Open items before we can bind

- **Confirm which twelve TriNet plans are available, and that the Aetna ACO 6500 is among them.** The floor of \$269.50 is keyed to its \$385 employee-only rate. This is the only TriNet item left that can move a number.
- **Get the Banner Health Network Arizona provider directory** and check Steven's and Jessica's physicians against it. The ACO 6500 is the best plan in the PEO field on our math and it is narrow-network; if it does not hold their doctors, TriNet's strongest asset comes off the table.
- Confirm Angle's TRAD 2000/4000 tier rates with CapFi, and ask for its setup fee.
- Obtain Insuperity's life and LTD rates, **and its actual workers' comp rates** — the \$994 in this report is our estimate from its own per-employee allocations.
- **Decide whether Onyx funds ADP's basic life and LTD** now that ADP has confirmed both are elective. Keeping them costs \$209/yr; our stated benefit design includes them.
- **Decide whether Onyx funds dental and vision at ADP or TriNet.** Both permit \$0, so it is a straight policy choice worth \$1,320/yr. At Insuperity it is not a choice — the \$27.50 minimum applies.
- Confirm Jessica's benefit eligibility date against October 1 **at ADP and Insuperity**. TriNet has confirmed the waiting period is ours to set, including none.
- **Decide whether to fund Steven at 100%** now that TriNet has confirmed class-based funding tiers. It costs Onyx \$1,992/yr on the ACO 6500 and buys him no tax advantage, since the contribution is W-2 wages to him either way. Ask ADP whether it permits the same structure.
- **Settle the referral partnership structure before agreeing to it.** Money paid back to Onyx is a referral fee under the AICPA Code — prohibited for attest clients, and requiring written disclosure for everyone else. A discount passed to the client avoids the rule entirely.
- Collect Josephine's signed waiver.
- Decide the employee+spouse contribution: hold at \$600, or move to ~\$678 to equalize Christine's subsidy.
- **Ask TriNet one question on the 401(k): what is the all-in expense ratio of the target-date series, and does the \$63 participant fee come out on top of it?** That single answer settles retirement. The lineup is not needed — the target-date figure is where a five-person plan will actually sit.
- Ask **both ADP and TriNet whether an adopting employer in their multiple employer plan still claims the SECURE 2.0 start-up credits**, and confirm with the tax preparer. Neither vendor addresses it and the answer depends on plan structure.
- Before adopting ADP's plan, get its **Summary Plan Description** (eligibility, entry dates, vesting, safe-harbor options) and its **Investment Policy Statement**, which is where 3(38) investment-fiduciary status would be stated if it exists. Neither changes the comparison; both matter at signing.
- Ask Insuperity for its **EPLI limit**, and whether recruiting, custom job descriptions, training and performance management are inside the \$183 PEPM or "nonstandard services" at extra cost.
- Ask ADP whether **Workforce Now Learning is included in the 1.53%** or an add-on purchase.
- Ask TriNet for **Electric upgrade tier pricing**. Unpriced, it cannot be counted as value.
- Ask TriNet what its **Aetna book actually renewed at** on the last two October cycles, and whether any cap or rate guarantee exists in the agreement.
- Ask TriNet what the **\$150/hour contribution-allocation charge** runs in a year for a five-person plan with a match — the only recurring 401(k) cost it bills Onyx.
- Shop IT support independently, on security and service merits rather than as a PEO bundle.
- **Quantify what Onyx pays for outside HR support today.** All three PEOs absorb it and Angle does not, so it is a real offset against the PEO fee and the largest priceable piece of Angle's scope gap.
- If Angle stays live, price standalone dental/vision, life, LTD, and payroll/HR/workers' comp/EPLI — without those, its \$34,800 is not comparable to the PEO totals.

* = after deductible · HSA = health savings account eligible · premium = 12 months of payroll deductions · care = the household's in-network out-of-pocket maximum, which caps treatment cost and never includes premium

Sources: TriNet Q-00412887 (Aetna and UHC strategies, 8/30/2026) · TriNet VROI 8/30/2026 · ADP TotalSource financial analysis 8/27/2026 · Insuperity HR360 bid versions 8143360-11 and -12, prepared 8/21/2026 · CapFi Consulting / Angle Health quote 400798, underwritten 7/30/2026.

Prepared by Josephine Mack · Onyx Accounting Group · September 2, 2026. Figures re-rated to actual enrollment; not an offer of insurance and not tax advice.